

### 3.11.4 Offline UPS

This UPS powers the system through the mains power till it fails, when it switches over to the battery backup. This is the cheapest and most widely available UPS.

### 3.11.5 Online UPS / Continuous UPS

This is the most reliable of UPS since the system is never powered by the mains. This type of UPS is mostly seen for servers or other critical equipment. The UPS is always working and the system is being powered off the backup batteries. This ensures that any problems with the mains supply is never felt by the system. In this scenario, when the mains power fails, there is no switchover.

### 3.11.6 Power Management Software

Many UPS bundle additional software that can be used to shut-down the system when the power level falls below a threshold. A serial cable connects the UPS to the system so that the necessary commands can be passed.

### 3.11.7 Switch Over Time

This is the time taken by the UPS to switch from utility power to battery power in the event of failure of utility power.

### 3.11.8 VA

Short for Volt Amperes, this refers to the load bearing capability of the UPS. The higher the VA rating, the greater the supported load. The supported load refers to the total power requirements of the PC. Since electrically Watts = VA, the total wattage of the components of the system is a good indicator of the suggested VA rating of the UPS that will be needed. It is recommended to leave some headroom and settle for an UPS marked at least 20% higher.